

Functions of Emotional Approach

Emotion

An emotion is a relatively brief episode of coordinated brain, autonomic, and behavioral changes that facilitate a response to an external or internal event of significance for the organism.

Emotion could be in any form as it will be fear, happiness, sad, or even normal mood of anyone.

Emotions are always change due to changing in the circumstances and events near the people.

Example

Fear is a good illustrative example. Imagine that you are hiking in the woods. Suddenly, you come across a bear. The bear is an external event that has clear significance for you since it could potentially kill you. Suddenly, you find that your heart is beating faster, you begin to sweat, and a feeling of panic washes through your mind. You immediately turn around and run back down the trail at full speed. In this case, the physiological changes facilitated the fleeing response.

Feeling

Feelings correspond to the subjective experience of emotions. They are what it is like to feel afraid, sad, or jubilant. Feelings, though, are internal and subjective; they are the way you as an individual experience the emotion.

Basic emotion

A basic emotion is one that is believed to be mostly innate and in humans ought to be universal or found in all cultures. Basic emotions may also contribute in various combinations to form other more complex emotions (Plutchik, 1980).

Charles Darwin

Charles Darwin first suggested that there might be basic emotions not just in humans but in animals as well. He noted that people, regardless of background, all use similar facial expressions to convey particular emotions

Theory of emotion (James, 1884; Lang, 1994)

Since emotions were first studied psychologically, there has been controversy over how they are caused. According to the James-Lange theory of emotion, there is an event that produces arousal and other physiological changes in the body (James, 1884; Lang, 1994). These physiological changes are then interpreted. The result of the interpretation is the emotion.

Imagine that you are walking down a city street late at night. A man lurches toward you from an alley, holding what appears to be a gun. According to this view, the sight of the man would cause your heart to beat faster; only then would you be aware of your heart's acceleration and experience fear.

Emotions and memory

What might be the role of emotion in regard to memory processes? One obvious prediction is that we should remember events surrounding emotional situations better. Since emotional events are important to our survival,

it makes sense that our memory systems should be set up this way. Imagine being chased by a tiger. If you climbed up a tree to escape and have a strong recollection of that event, then you should be more likely to employ the same strategy the next time you find yourself in that situation. So there is a clear evolutionary benefit to this type of memory system

Emotion and decision making (Thagard (2008))

outlines some of the differences between emotional (intuitive) and rational (calculated) decision making. **Intuitive decisions** are fast; they can be made immediately and lead directly to a decision.

This is preferable when **making less important judgments**, such as whether you should order out for pizza or Chinese food. However, they are prone to error because they may be based on inaccurate or irrelevant information.

When making **calculated decisions**, we usually consider more alternatives and goals, understand the pros and cons of each, and make the entire process explicit so that we can go back and rethink it or get somebody else to help.

This process is slower but is the way we would want to approach important problems in our lives, such as whether or not we should marry someone or accept a job offer.

Emotions and Reasoning Analogies (Thagard (2008))

analogies can be considered as a type of mental representation. They **can be used in problem solving and decision making** by applying what we know in one situation to another similar to it.

Type of Analogies lists three types of analogies defined by their relation to emotion.

- First, there are **analogies that are about emotions**.
- Second, there are **analogies that involve the transfer of emotion between situations**.
- Third, there are **analogies that generate new emotions**.

We detail each of these types below

We often use analogies to describe our mental states. Perhaps this is because it is difficult to describe what a thought or feeling is like in literal terms. Analogies of the second type that are used to transfer emotion are found in persuasion, empathy, and reverse empathy (Thagard, 2008). We often use analogies when we are trying to persuade somebody.

Functions of Emotions (Hyisung and David Matsumoto)

Emotions play a crucial role in our lives because they have an important function. This model describes those functions, dividing the decision into three are Intrapersonal, Interpersonal and the social and cultural functions emotions.

Intrapersonal function of emotions

The intrapersonal function of emotion which refer to the role that emotions play within each of us individually, and the second one not involves in our own feeling or thought and our emotions also limited with in our own self.

It is also a rapid information processing system that help us act with in minimal thinking (Tooby and Cosmides, 2008).

Interpersonal function of emotions

The interpersonal function of emotions refer to the role emotions play between individuals within a group, that may define two or more people in involve into the emotion of every person who is belong to them. They able to change the emotion of each other through the communication.

Cultural function of emotions

The cultural function of emotion refers to the role that emotions play in the maintenance of social order within a society. All in all, we will see that emotions inform us of who we are, what our relationships with other are like, and how to behave in social interactions.

Emotions give meaning to events, without emotions, those events would be mere facts, emotions help coordinate interpersonal relationships, and emotions play an important role in the cultural functioning of keeping human societies together.

Emotion influence Thoughts

Emotions are also connected to thoughts and memories. Memories are not just facts that are encoded in our brains, they are colored with the emotions felt at those time the facts occurred (Wang and Ross 2007).

Thus, emotions serve as the neural glue that connects those disparate facts in our minds. That is why it is easier to remember happy thoughts when happy, and angry thoughts when angry.

